

Part 2 of 2

Digital Forensics and Investigation: Computer Forensics Tools



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In the first part of this article, last month, we discussed digital forensics and investigation, the three phases of forensics investigation, legal considerations, branches of digital forensics, digital forensic and investigation teams, and applications of digital forensics. In this part, we look at the various computer forensics tools available.

Computer forensics techniques are essential to successfully prevent, detect,

investigate and prosecute electronic crime. Evidence can be found on such media sources as CD-ROMs/DVD-ROMs, mobile phones, hard disks, computer memories, floppy disks, flash drives, memory cards, email servers, Web servers and others. Each category may require a separate forensics tool or hybrid tool. Forensic tools have been developed for different operating systems (OSes) such as Linux, Mac OS or Windows.

Let us take a look at the various tools that help in digital forensics and investigation process. Many of these tools are open source, while the others are proprietary. These tools may be evaluated based on various criterion such as completeness in functionality, time taken by the tool to perform its task, user friendliness and ease of use, cost and acceptability of the tool in the court of law.

Table I features some general computer forensics tools that the investigators may use.



Fig. 1: Logicube forensic SF-5000 kit, the ultimate weapon against cyber crime

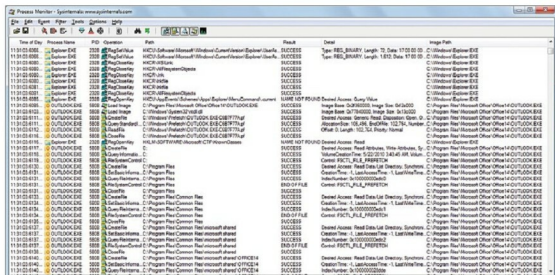


Fig. 2: Process monitor